



**NORTHERN SETTLEMENT
SERVICES LIMITED**



**Annual Report
2017 / 18**

OUR MISSION STATEMENT

**To be a leading regional
organisation working with
Culturally and Linguistically Diverse (CALD)
individuals, families and communities,
providing services that strengthen
and inspire people in an environment that is
culturally sensitive and responsive to
their needs and goals.**

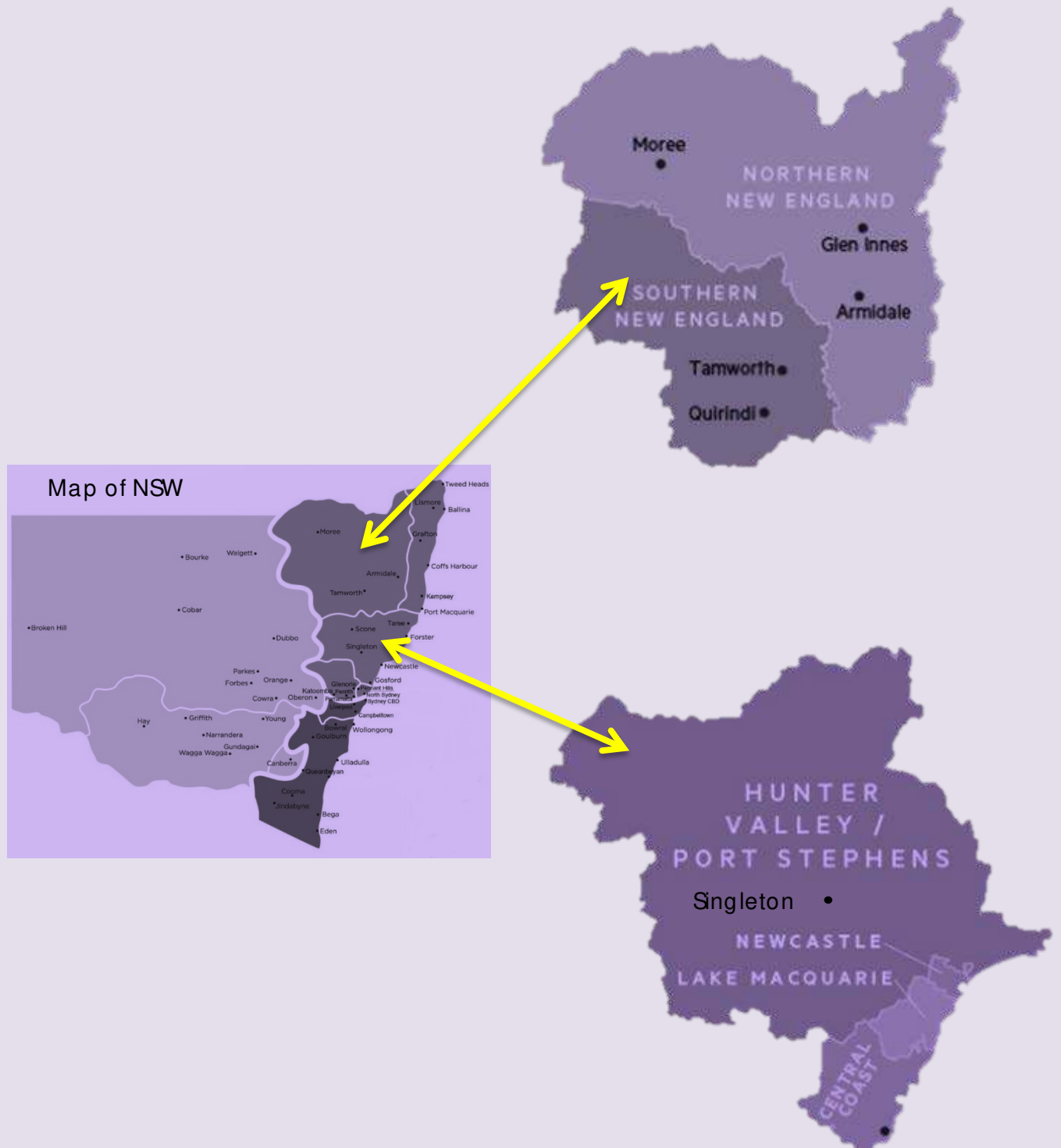
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SERVICE COVERAGE AREAS

2



BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Ms Trudy Mills-Evers AM	Chair
Mr Jon Chin	Deputy Chair
Ms Christine Jordan	Treasurer, Public Officer
Ms Ewa Korczynski	Secretary
Ms Anna Bailey	Director
Mr Zoran Vasiljevic	Director
Ms Sania Young	Director
Father Nicholas Zervas OAM	Director
Mr Zachary Ekandi	Director
Cr. Barney Langford	Co-opted Member, Lake Macquarie City Council
Cr. Carol Duncan	Co-opted Member, Newcastle City Council

Our Supporters

We wish to acknowledge and thank all of our funding bodies and stakeholders for their continued support of the many and diverse programs delivered throughout the past year.



ORGANISATIONAL ACHIEVEMENTS

1,860

CLIENTS PROVIDED
INDIVIDUAL
SUPPORT



PER SESSION / INSTANCE OF SERVICE

1,040

PEOPLE PARTICIPATED
IN GROUP
ACTIVITIES



PER SESSION / INSTANCE OF SERVICE

APPROXIMATELY

9,301

CLIENTS WERE
SUPPORTED BY
VOLUNTEERS



PER SESSION / INSTANCE OF SERVICE

WELFARE TEAM

5,004

INDIVIDUALS & FAMILIES
SUPPORTED THROUGH
GROUP ACTIVITIES
PER SESSION / INSTANCE OF SERVICE

350

INDIVIDUAL CASE
MANAGEMENT PROVIDED
PER SESSION / INSTANCE OF SERVICE

250

GROUPS DELIVERED

AGED CARE TEAM

282

HOME CARE PACKAGE &
COMMONWEALTH SUPPORT
PROGRAMME RECIPIENTS

55

COMMUNITY VISITORS
SCHEME RECIPIENTS

22,860 CLIENT ATTENDANCES

233

PEOPLE WERE
ASSISTED
THROUGH THE
ENERGY ACCOUNTS
PAYMENT ASSISTANCE
SCHEME (EAPA)

108

PEOPLE PROVIDED
TAX HELP

CLIENTS CAME FROM
MORE THAN

70 DIFFERENT COUNTRIES



SETTLEMENT TEAM

1,912

INDIVIDUAL SUPPORT
PROVIDED
PER SESSION / INSTANCE OF SERVICE

2,890

CASES
PER SESSION / INSTANCE OF SERVICE

652

INDIVIDUALS & FAMILIES
SUPPORTED THROUGH
GROUP ACTIVITIES
PER SESSION / INSTANCE OF SERVICE

IMMIGRATION TEAM

1,778

SESSIONS PROVIDED

156

INDIVIDUAL CASE

320 ACTIVE volunteers

Central Coast, Newcastle, Armidale, Tamworth

Volunteers
supported a **TOTAL**
of **9,301**
clients

Central Coast, Newcastle,
Armidale, Tamworth

(attendances)

Breakdown by program:

Educational Programs

2,346

Newcastle & Armidale

Settlement & Community Support

4,124

Central Coast, Newcastle, Armidale, Tamworth

Aged Care Support

2,831

Central Coast & Newcastle

Volunteers provided
14,261
HOURS of support
to clients

Central Coast, Newcastle,
Armidale, Tamworth

Breakdown by program:

Educational Programs

3,364

Newcastle & Armidale

Settlement & Community Support

3,642

Central Coast, Newcastle, Armidale, Tamworth

Aged Care Support

7,255

Central Coast & Newcastle

Note: Figures are approximate.



CHAIRPERSON'S REPORT

Trudy Mills - Evers AM

This is a special report for me as I hereby announce my retirement from the Board of Northern Settlement Services (NSS), after more than 30 years of service to the organisation.

With the adoption of the new NSS constitution at the AGM in November 2017 and the development and implementation of a 3 year strategic plan it seems like an appropriate time for me to step down as we introduce a skilled based-board with expertise in areas of governance, risk management, finance, legal framework and service delivery to lead the organisation to achieve its strategic objectives.

These are challenging times for the not-for-profit sector. Government reform means that more than ever we need to be flexible and responsive to these changes. The current trends are for government to tender out more and more of social services, opening up the field to for-profit providers.

My journey that began 30 years ago as the Migrant Resource Centre of Newcastle and the Hunter Region, and subsequently NSS has seen this organisation grow from a staff of 2 to more than 70 employees.

As more CALD people settled in regional areas, so our specialist services expanded across the Hunter, Central Coast and New England, delivering a wide range of settlement support services from early childhood through to Aged Care to a diverse mix of CALD communities in our catchment area.

Over the years of my involvement, NSS has always been a very harmonious work place with stable and very committed staff. The organisation has enjoyed a continuity of management, and an accompanying stability that is rare in the community sector, and I believe these factors have made an undeniable contribution to the operation of NSS, creating an environment which engenders harmonious community relations, responsive service providers, and a receptive host community.

One of our longer serving staff members, Alex Burns, universally known and respected, who is also retiring at this year's AGM, has devoted his career to supporting, advising and advocating on the needs and issues affecting people from CALD background in the rural centres of the Mid and Far North Coast, the North West, and the Central West regions of NSW.

Further with the ageing of the post war migrant population, it became

very clear that tailored Aged Care Services were required to assist our ageing CALD communities in the Hunter, adding yet another complementary program to our service delivery area.

Volunteers have always been the back bone of our organisation. NSS currently has 320 active volunteers who have supported over 9,000 clients and provided over 14,000 hours of client support this year alone! These magnificent people give their time freely in our educational programs, settlement and community support and aged care areas.

Further details of the organisations achievements are outlined in this Annual Report and I congratulate our dedicated staff on jobs well done. Thank you to our CEO, Lulu, for her commitment to excellence.

The whole Board has worked harmoniously and effectively throughout the year, putting attention to detail in every task. I wish to thank all Board members past and present for their critical input and their willingness to give their time, expertise and support to this great organisation.

The Board and I have always worked constructively with our staff and it has been a pleasure to serve this organisation. I feel we have consolidated our role in the region as a credible and effective service agency, collaborative in its relationships with its funding sources, supporting and advocating on behalf of

constituents, and always looking for new opportunities to develop the best services we can to meet the challenges of the time.

I especially want to thank our former and present CEO for their vision and leadership in serving our clients.

I wish our members, staff and communities all the best for the future as I reflect with pride on our achievements.



NSS CHAIR TRUDY MILLS-EVERS AM ADDRESSING NSS MEMBERS AT LAST YEAR'S AGM



CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER'S REPORT

Lulu Tantos

I would like to commence this report by acknowledging the outstanding contribution made to this organisation by our outgoing chairperson, Ms Trudy Mills-Evers AM, and thank her for her leadership over the last 6 years as Chair and her 30 years as Board Director.

On behalf of her fellow Directors and staff, I would like to thank Trudy for the commitment and personal investment she brought to the organisation over her term. Trudy has been integral to the important advances we have made as an organisation over the last 6 years as Chair of NSS.

I would also like to pay tribute and say thank you to two other long serving outgoing Board Directors.

- Father Nicholas Zervas OAM
- Christine Jordan

Board Service is the toughest volunteer role and each of them took on their Board duties with dedication, grace and seriousness.

I am most grateful to all of them for their active leadership and careful deliberation on matters before the Board, even when the decisions were difficult.

As a famous peace activist once said, "wisdom is knowing what to do next, virtue is doing it". You are all wise and virtuous and we are grateful you shared those qualities as an NSS Board member.

During the 2017-18 year the Board, Senior Management and staff all

played a role in developing a 3 year strategic plan directing the future development of NSS in an open and consultative process, as we remain committed to ensuring that refugees, humanitarian entrants and other migrants in our catchment area remain supported and resourced to their full potential as members of the Australian community.

Another particular focus for NSS this year and has been on the safety, welfare and well-being of our ageing CALD communities, children, young people and their families and we hold these at the forefront of our planning, actions and decisions.

The active involvement of our clients in decisions about their lives and the services they need is fundamental to our person centred approach.

Through a consideration of internal and external issues NSS continues to fulfil and maintain its role as a key provider of services to CALD communities in the Hunter, Central Coast, and New England regions of NSW.

Contained within the report you will find detailed information on the activities and achievements of NSS over the year and evidence of the difference our services have made and continue to make to people's lives. I would like to thank all our service users, participants and stakeholders for trusting us to provide them with services to meet their needs and wants.

Let me say, however, that last year has not been without its uncertainties. Our ability to deliver services has been impacted on by all manner of political and social reforms which meant that we have needed to be very flexible and pragmatic in our approach. Our existence as a service for migrants/refugees has been regularly punctuated by reviews and reappraisals.

So, in a challenging era of State and Federal reforms, e.g. Family & Community Services (FACS) Targeted Early Intervention (TEI), Aged Care, Settlement, that require us to be competitive, NSS is ensuring that our organisation maintains its ability not only to be responsive to community needs but be efficient through a low cost structure, particularly in aged care, in delivering quality services.

I'd like to conclude by thanking the Board, Senior Management and the Staff for their support and efforts in what has been a hectic but rewarding year for the organisation.

As the service delivery capacity of NSS continues to grow, I look forward to us continuing to play a central role not just in supporting those in immediate need, but also working collaboratively with our partners and with all levels of Government, to help create policies and services that ensure the best possible outcomes for our service users.



CEO LULU TANTOS PRESENTING NSS BOARD MEMBER A
CERTIFICATE OF APPRECIATION FOR VOLUNTEERING



VOLUNTEER WEEK

SETTLEMENT SERVICES



Settlement Team - Newcastle



Alex Burns
*Settlement Team Manager
Newcastle / Hunter*



Lydia Manusiu
*Senior Settlement Worker
Newcastle*



Rose Oku
*Settlement Worker Hunter
Outreach*



Lena Alameddine
*Settlement Worker (Arabic)
Volunteer Coordinator Welfare*



Tonkoh Kamara
Youth Worker



Michael Freund
*Volunteers Coordinator
Education*



Abby Tinlin
*Settlement Worker
Pathways to Volunteering
Coordinator
Volunteers Coordinator Welfare*



Marie Zawadi
Settlement Worker Newcastle

Alex Burns Settlement Support and Communities

Team Manager Newcastle / Hunter

Project Target Group

New arrival eligible migrant, refugee and humanitarian people in the first 5 years of their settlement in Australia.

Project Coverage Area

Newcastle and the Hunter Valley

Project brief

The broad aim of the Settlement Services program is to deliver services which assist clients in the Newcastle and Hunter Valley area to become self-reliant and participate equitably in Australian society, with a focus on fostering social participation, economic well-being, independence, personal well-being and community connectedness. In addition the program requires the engagement with other services to support the broad aim of the Settlement program in both service practices and through advocacy.

Service Highlights and achievements Service Delivery

The Data Exchange (DEX) indicates that over 53 per cent of the client group of 743 clients provided services in the Newcastle and Hunter area were female. This is fairly consistent with services given to our client group over the preceding years. It is also clear that even with an NSS total settlement client target of 600 clients for 2017-18 year; this was well exceeded by the Newcastle Settlement Team.

The country of birth background for the top eight client groups is shown in the table below with most clients assisted coming from Afghanistan and Syria.

Table 1: Country of Birth of the Newcastle Settlement Clients

Country of Birth	Numbers of Clients
Afghanistan	199
Syria	193
Democratic Republic of Congo	29
Iraq	25
India	22
Philippines	22
Sudan	13
Iran	11

Source: DEX 2017-18

The ages of the clients indicates a young cohort with only 2% of those assisted being over 65 years, while 15% were children 9 years and under. The majority of our clients were youth (10-19 years - 24% and 20-39 years 49%) and again highlights a vulnerability of age with very few older people from Afghanistan or Syria to guide and advise these new arrivals.

87% of services provided by the Newcastle Team included general information/advice, advocacy/support/referral, education and skills training assistance. Engagement with other support services for support was high with over 1200 referrals being made especially to the Department of Human Services, NSS Migration Agent, EAPA, various women's services, children's services and Neighbourhood Centres.

Support Groups

During the year the Newcastle Team worked to provide ongoing information and support in a variety of ways. In the Hunter, support groups

were located at Singleton and Cessnock with social support, information and advocacy being provided. The groups participated in a range of activities including Riverlights at Maitland and an Expo at Muswellbrook and had information sessions on legal Aid, Centrelink, breast cancer awareness, drug and alcohol use.

activities such as learn to swim with the STARTTS swimming program at WallSEND Swimming Centre and with the Cooks Hill Life Saving Club in their "Welcome to the Beach" program. The Women participated in a number of events including a Multicultural end of year women's picnic held by NSS and Max Solutions in Jesmond Park. Other events included attendance at Harmony Days in Lake Macquarie,



In Newcastle three support groups were developed and met monthly. These included an Afghan Women's Group held at the Jesmond Neighbourhood Centre, an Arabic Women's Group held at the Jesmond Uniting Church and an Afghan Men's group also held at the Jesmond Neighbourhood Centre. The Women group's participated in a number of different information sessions with speakers from the Department of Justice, the Roads and Maritime Services, Health, Services NSW as well as the NSS Migration Agent presenting on Australian Citizenship. They were also involved in a number of life skills

Jesmond and Newcastle as well as attending Riverlights at Maitland.

In April NSS led a School Holiday Program as an extension to its group work program targeting newly arrived children mainly from Syria aged 8 to 11 years.

The Afghan Men's Group began operation at the beginning of 2018 with a consultation and information sessions on Australian Citizenship, employment, housing and health. The men's group was organised to accommodate those working and those looking for work and took place in the evening with the aim being to meet the group's needs.

Youth Programs

2017-18 has been a busy year for the NSS youth program area as we continue to focus on the growing needs of CALD young people across our regions. Highlights from this period include:

NEWCASTLE - HUNTER

Pathways to Volunteering Project

Funded by Multicultural NSW. The project aim was to provide community education on the concept and value of volunteering and linking CALD clients to local volunteering opportunities. The project duration was 12 months and it was delivered to approximately 130 CALD clients. There were 10 information sessions, 25 people formally registered in volunteering and 9 community members commencing volunteering. This program provided opportunities for clients to acquire skills that would be useful for future employment opportunities.

Pilates Program

A program designed to engage young migrant and refugee female youth in exercise. This program was a result of previous consultations focusing on activities of interest. 11 young females from ages 12 to 17 attended. NSS ran the program on a weekly basis within Term 4, 2017 at Jesmond Neighbourhood Centre. The formation of this group resulted in increased physical activity and created social networks.

Multicultural Youth Group - Newcastle

This youth group is a partnership between STARTTS and NSS with support from other agencies such as Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre (MNC), Headspace, Northlakes Youth Services, NSW Police and Refugee Hub. Over 50 young people were engaged with a weekly attendance of between 20-35 young people. This group has helped to reduce reactive behaviour and ensured an increased awareness of youth services for support. The group meets every Wednesday afternoon at Callaghan Jesmond College.

Welcome Ride

A joint program with Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre, Samaritans, Headspace, STARTTS, Northlakes Youth Services, Refugee Hub, NSW Police and Wesley. Two welcome rides occurred during this period in July 2017 and January 2018. At least 30 to 40 young people attended each excursion. The aim of Welcome Ride is to introduce newly arrived young people to safe and valuable places of interest in the community and to foster long lasting relationships built on mutual understanding, fun, friendship and trust.



2017 Youth Cultural Exchange

An annual event which has been arranged by NSS and Manning Valley Neighbourhood Services in partnership with other services, e.g. MNC for over 5 years. Newly arrived migrant and refugee young people are given the opportunity to go on a road trip to Manning Valley and Port Macquarie LGA to interact with students from local schools. Around 16 young people from Newcastle participated. The cultural exchange provides a vehicle for inclusion, drawing together young people from different schools, different races, faiths and cultures.

Multicultural NSW Support Grant

This one off grant supported 20 young people in registering with the Jesmond Football Club and Samurai Judo Academy. It also assisted in purchasing uniforms. All the young people were from refugee background with 18 being boys and 2 being girls. This grant provided an opportunity for financially struggling families to support their children in engaging local sports.

CENTRAL COAST

Links to Learning

A program delivered to year 9 students by the Settlement Service Program (SSP) worker on the Central Coast raising awareness to mainstream youth of challenges facing CALD youth. 3 groups of year 9 students were targeted. This program supported vulnerable youth to gain confidence in accessing services.

NEW ENGLAND

Multicultural Youth Group & Mentoring - Armidale

SSP worker in Armidale has engaged with CALD youth in forming a Multicultural Youth Group. The group has met on 12 occasions.

CALD youth have actively been involved in determining the purpose and function of a Multicultural Youth Group in Armidale. They have also been actively involved in the definition and consideration of CALD youth issues and needs in the Armidale Region. Two of the migrant youth representatives have attended the Armidale Regional Council Youth Advocacy Network Meetings. The SSP worker continues to provide ongoing mentoring to the group.

HOMEWORK CENTRES

The youth homework centres are an integral part of the NSS Youth Program and are aimed at developing partnerships with local schools to facilitate relationships between students, school staff and parents/guardians.

English as an Additional Language or Dialect (EALD) HWC - Armidale

A homework centre is operating in Armidale at Drummond Memorial Primary School. This homework centre provides a positive complimentary support to local EALD teachers and students. There were 84 sessions with 60 students.

HWC - Newcastle

7 homework centres have operated in the Newcastle area during this period. Two finished up at the end of 2017 which were Islington Public School and St Francis Xavier's College this was due to changes in areas where SSP clients were residing. As a result a HWC opened up at Shortland Public School in 2018 to support this change in trend. Jesmond Public School, Heaton Public School, Waratah Callaghan Technology Campus and Jesmond Senior Callaghan Campus are still in operation. There were 168 HWC sessions and over 70 volunteers. During Terms 3 and 4, 2017 there were 75 students enrolled and during Terms 1 and 2, 2018 there were 65 students enrolled.



NSS Learning Centres - above Waratah Technology Campus, Jesmond Public School and below Shortland Public School celebrating Harmony Day.



Settlement Team - Regional



Debbie Carstens
*Settlement Team Manager
Regional*



Nellie Sisirapon
*Settlement Worker
Central Coast*



Lance McNamara
*Settlement Worker
Armidale*



Amalin Sundaravej
*Settlement Worker
Tamworth*



Natalia Meliendrez
*Multicultural Community
Development
Central Coast*



Pari Batha
*Multicultural
Community
Development
Central Coast*

Debbie Carstens Settlement Services Manager Regional

Project Target Group(s):

Newly arrived people from migrant, refugee and humanitarian backgrounds in the first 5 years of their settlement in Australia; CALD families and communities on the Central Coast; CALD children 0-6 and their families.

Project Coverage Area(s):

Central Coast and New England (Armidale and Tamworth).

Project Brief:

Supporting the settlement of newly arrived people from migrant, refugee and humanitarian backgrounds in the first 5 years on the Central Coast and in the New England; Facilitating the engagement of CALD families and communities in the wider Central Coast community, building on their strengths and supporting them to address challenges; Supporting and enhancing early childhood development and wellbeing for children on the Central Coast.

Highlights and Achievements:

Armidale

In August 2017 the Federal government announced Armidale would become a new refugee settlement region, with an initial intake of up to 300 people. Settlement Services International (SSI), as the newly announced contractor for the Humanitarian Settlement Program (HSP) in the northern region, commenced the work of establishing the program and liaised with NSS in establishing initial connections. 136 people from refugee backgrounds had arrived in Armidale by the end of June 2018 largely from Iraq and Syria. This has impacted significantly on NSS's

work in Armidale as a greater focus has been brought on the local migrant and refugee population. NSS's office is now co-located with SSI in Armidale.

Armidale Carnivale Multicultural Music and Dance Festival was held for a second year and will become an annual event. Despite very cold weather, an estimated 600 people participated, with many people getting up to learn traditional dances from other cultures, and people commenting "It was wonderful to see so many people from different backgrounds dancing and interacting with each other regardless of their language and culture".

Tamworth

NSS worked extensively and creatively with the Karen people from Burma who have settled in Tamworth, and those arriving from other parts of Australia. Activities have included negotiating targeted vocational courses for the young adults, involving them in Clean Up Australia Day and a tree planting activity. Some of the most recently arrived have also been able to commence work, as their English language skills have improved and NSS has been able to advocate for them with employers.

Festa le Peel in October 2017 was a great event, this time led by Armidale Regional Council, with an estimated 7000 people present. There were some 40 countries represented, 63 stalls (non and commercial), and 20 entertainment acts from 15 countries.

In Refugee Week in June 2018 NSS worked with others to hold a trivia night based on the questions in the Citizenship Test.

Central Coast

Our Settlement worker provided casework to 97 clients with, 68 outreach visits including casework and advocacy, 12 agencies assisted with consultation on cultural information for their CALD clients.

The most common issues in case work are domestic and family violence, legal, income, housing and mental health. In addition 157 formal or warm referrals were made to other agencies, 119 informal referrals, and 31 people outside our Settlement target group were assisted with referrals as well.

English conversation class Talking Around the World (TATW) continues to have great outcomes for the group with language learning, sharing information to support settlement and building connections. Topics included aspects of the law, housing, finding employment, education pathways and road rules.

350 CALD community members attended the Central Coast Multicultural Expo with the theme "Be Safe" in October 2017 under the auspice of the Central Coast Multicultural Interagency with extensive involvement from our NSS team with 50 services sharing information and promoting their services. Workshops were delivered on law enforcement, First Aid and spider awareness. Health checks were also provided.

Cultural Responsiveness Training is another aspect of our work. On the Central Coast NSS delivered regular training to organisations to enable their workforce to understand and relate respectfully to people of different cultural backgrounds.

NSS has also undertaken consultations with groups of parents from the Spanish speaking, Russian, Iranian and Muslim communities to hear more about their strengths, challenges, hopes and dreams, and to identify new ways we could be supporting them. The Spanish speaking women want to have their own Playgroup under the auspice of NSS. All of the women want more information about low cost family activities they can participate on the coast, are looking for ways to meet more regularly for mutual support and want to work together to help their children learn/retain their language and cultural heritage. The Iranian women are interested in starting a Farsi language school for their children as their small community grows, and are also interested in gaining long term employment for themselves.

The Russian Playing Around the World (PAW) Group has been increasingly run by the women themselves, with two mothers taking significant leadership. Their Christmas Play in Russian was a highlight.

Playing Around the World (PAW) - Communities for Children

Blue Haven and The Entrance PAW groups have had another very successful year with children and parents learning many new skills. Highlights included Book Week, when everyone dressed up as a favourite character, and Harmony Day when they were joined by local primary school children to share in a range of entertainment and activities. Healthy eating, Small Talk parenting skills, and daily reading to children were among the topics explored and modelled. 75 sessions were held in the 12 months, with 63 children and 52 parents participating. Families involved were

from Russia, The Philippines, New Zealand, Nepal, USA, Ukraine, Portugal, South Korea, Greece, Australia, China, Hong Kong, UK, India, France, Brazil, Spain, Venezuela, Colombia, Peru, Chile, Bolivia, South Africa, Thailand, Tonga, Syria, Indonesia, Japan, Scotland and Iran.

Multicultural Interagencies

NSS continues to convene the New England Multicultural Interagency (NEMI, quarterly) and the Central Coast Multicultural Interagency (CCMI, bi-monthly). These are important and active forums for raising the profile of the CALD community, sharing information about various initiatives and problem solving on issues of concern. The CCMI has been pleased to have increased engagement with the Police this year as concerns with Police not using interpreters or being culturally responsive have led to distress for some CALD community members. NEMI has been following the new settlement of refugees into Armidale and has identified public transport as a significant issue for migrant and refugee communities across the region.

Mingoola

Several years ago Great Lakes Agency for Peace and Development International (GLAPDI) identified that many of the Great Lakes African families living in cities were yearning to get back on the land and farm, as they had done in their country of origin. A chance meeting put GLAPDI in touch with the Mingoola Progress Association, giving birth to this innovative settlement project.

NSS role was to support families from African backgrounds settled into that community, and interview the families

and other community members and stakeholders about the joys, challenges, hopes and dreams of all of them in supporting this significant move. NSS has been invited to partner with GLAPDI in order to assist in reflecting on and documenting the Mingoola project, the outcomes for the families and the community, and the challenges of regional resettlement in this form. This provides a platform for reflection for GLAPDI and the communities involved, a chance to identify opportunities to value add to the regional resettlement outcomes, and to inform other organisations who might seek to pursue the resettlement model GLAPDI has developed.

NSW Settlement Partnership

The partnership held a Showcase in late 2017, telling stories and launching a booklet of case studies of projects and outcomes of our settlement work individually and together. NSS featured in 3 very different case studies - our work with other agencies on the Central Coast to produce a DVD and Facilitator's Guide for use in education about domestic and family violence in the CALD community; the Mingoola documenting project; and the Cultural Exchange where NSS takes groups of young people from refugee backgrounds to visit schools in the Manning Valley.

NSS continues to be an active participant in the NSW Settlement Partnership (NSP) meetings and greatly value the exchange of information and the joint activity we undertake to further the positive settlement outcomes of the people with whom we work.

Employment Services

Project Target Group(s):

CALD community in Newcastle who are seeking employment or are under employed.

Project Coverage Region(s) and Area(s):

Newcastle.

Project Brief:

The aim of the NSS Employment Project is to:

- Improve the employment outcomes for people from migrant and refugee backgrounds
- Engage Job Active and other Employment Service Providers to better understand and respond to our target group
- Provide programs that fill gaps or better serve the target group
- Engage employers in understanding what our target group offers, and valuing productive diversity

Hunter Multicultural Employment Reference Group

It is now more than 2 years since we commenced convening the Multicultural Employment Reference Group through which we have engaged all the job active providers and several other employment service providers in the region. The Reference Group has significantly raised the profile of our target group among funded employment services, and provided a vehicle for information sharing on our respective services and

a mutual understanding of challenges. It has been a forum for raising complaints about poor practice, clarifications of misunderstandings, and problem solving together on issues impacting on services. Activities we have undertaken together included:

- Collaboration with job active providers to achieve outcomes for groups of clients - a) Food Safety Certificates - negotiated with TAFE by NSS and payment by Job Active Providers, b) Driving Lessons - professional lessons through Job Active payment followed up by volunteer driving lessons with NSS, c) NSS link people to employment through our networks, and job active providers support services including interpreters for interviews and induction.
- Employment Consultations - Jointly facilitated a consultation with Arabic speakers around the skills they have and the challenges they are facing, with an opportunity for Job Actives to respond/problem solve with ideas and models for seeking accessible employment in the Newcastle region. The Department of Jobs and Small Business Employer Liaison Officer talked with the Afghan men's group about the nature of employment opportunities in the region and discussed pathways for people with the various skills they have.
- Contact Lists - we regularly updated and shared contact lists of local Employment Service Providers and of local

Multicultural Service Providers, with contact people for information sharing, working together and trouble shooting. They also provide job active with targeted information about who they can go to for assistance with clients from migrant and refugee backgrounds.

Employment Mentoring Program

In April 2018 NSS developed an employment mentoring program to engage skilled volunteers to assist migrants and refugees with writing resumes and cover letters, cold calling, job seeking skills, interview skills. This compliments and fills the gaps in the job active service provision. By the end of June, NSS had already supported several people with resumes and had recruited and trained 4 volunteers. Volunteers were ready to start working with their first clients in July.

Engagement with Employers

Employers have contacted NSS seeking workers, and we have been able to introduce groups of workers to them for interview. We have continued to support workers and employers to address any issues arising through mutual cultural misunderstandings or challenges related to settlement in Australia. Where workers have been linked to a job active, we have co-ordinated with the job active to provide support from their program to further enhance the employment sustainability. Linking the people we have supported with resumes into employment is a further outcome we

have been able to achieve from the mentoring program.

Multicultural Small Business Program

Our partnership with Newcastle City Council and The Business Centre continued this year to deliver a second multicultural small business program on a very different model. After considerable evaluation of the pilot program in 2017 and deliberation on a range of models, a program of one on one mentoring was developed with the engagement of an experienced Arabic speaking Business Advisor. His language and cross cultural skills, alongside the local Newcastle knowledge of The Business Centre and the additional funding from the Newcastle City Council resulted in a very effective model for supporting our refugee cohort into a range of small business endeavours. Four small businesses are emerging from his program, with ten other clients also accessing the program to explore their business ideas.



Outcomes

We have seen great outcomes for our client group through this Employment Project including:

- Increased use of interpreters by job actives in the region – noted by Department of Jobs and Small Business
- Some job actives are engaging a regular interpreter in certain languages
- Greater mutual understanding of service provided by each others services - employment service providers and multicultural sector providers
- Collaborative work to move people into employment and help keep them there
- Increased number of clients from refugee backgrounds gaining employment
- A number of clients exploring and working towards establishing small businesses
- Organising flow of activity to compliment each others services, for example one job active provider paid for 5 -10 driving lessons with an interpreter in the car, and then NSS volunteers continued with driving training so people could

get a licence, which in turn assists in gaining employment

- Regular conversations with job actives to trouble shoot on issues
- Sharing of information about clients and resources to support employment outcomes

Key Ingredients in Positive Outcomes

- Collaboration between job active providers and multicultural sector agencies, and collaboration between job active providers
- Building relationships of mutual respect and understanding



AGED SERVICES



Aged Care Services Team



Pasa Bajalis
*Aged Services Team
Manager*



John Biswas
Sector Support & Development



Stefanie Maier
*Home Care Packages
Coordinator*



Lupe Fonua
*Home Care Packages
Coordinator*



Tima Oto
*Multicultural Social Support
Coordinator*



Hunter Irene Lupish
*Community Visitors Scheme
Coordinator Hunter*



Dongmei Zhang
*Chinese Social Support
Coordinator*



Katie Livingstone
*Multicultural In Home Respite
Coordinator*



Marilín Pérez Cabrera
*Multicultural Social Support
Central Coast*



Natalia Meliendrez
*Multicultural Social Support
Central Coast*



Kellie Matterson
*Multicultural In Home Respite
Coordinator
Central Coast*



Kathy Karimodini
*Community Visitors Scheme
Coordinator
Central Coast*

Rasa Bajalis – Team Manager - Aged Services

Project Coverage:

Hunter and the Central Coast regions.

Project Scope:

It is with pleasure that I report on the activities of the Aged Care Services team for the last year. As anticipated 2017 - 2018 has been a hectic and exciting due to the fast pace of the ongoing Aged Care reforms.

The NSS Aged Care Team is dedicated to delivering support and services for older people over 65 years and their carers wishing to continue living quality and independent lives in their own homes. We work to create opportunities for our clients to connect with others, encouraging social cohesiveness and lessening the potential for isolation.

We offer culturally appropriate and responsive services which focus on wellness, reablement and independence.

Our Aged Care Service is comprised of three main program areas which are all funded by the Department of Health: Home Care Packages, Community Visitors Scheme, Commonwealth Home Support Program which includes Individual Social Support, Flexible Respite and Sector Support and Development.

We continue with repositioning ourselves to accommodate the changing face of the Australian Aged Care sector. At NSS we remain focused on supporting and empowering the older person in our community to make informed choices about the aged care they receive. By choosing their individual care and supports that's best for them, our care

recipients can have the quality of life they truly deserve.

The reviewed Commonwealth Home Support Programme Manual was released in 2018 with a strong focus on activities that support independence and social connectedness and taking into account each person's individual goals, preferences and choices.

June 2018 saw the end of funding from Aged, Disability and Home Care (ADHC) of the disability portion for the Sector Support and Development position.

The Aged Care team now comprises 12 coordinators and 18 care support staff supporting the Hunter and the Central Coast areas. We are proud of the enhancement of the delivery of care to our programmes with the steady growth of bi-cultural care support workers. Our staff is from a variety of cultural backgrounds - Chinese, Russian, Polish, German, Filipino, Tibetan, Italian, Uganda, Zambia and Australian - and are a good reflection of the population demographics we support in our targeted areas.

Home Care Packages:

The number of clients on a level 2 Home Care Package is almost equal to the number of clients receiving a level 3 or 4 Home Care Package (Total: 40 clients). This has enhanced the need for greater skills of case management and coordination.

The introduction of employing NSS care support staff has had a very positive impact in that NSS is able to match clients with workers who come from the same or similar CALD background. Also, by employing staff directly, NSS is saving on costs on brokerage which puts money back

into the client's budget. The overall feedback from clients has been very positive.

While the knowledge about Home Care Packages of My Aged Care staff still seems to vary greatly, there have been significant improvements to accessing information via the My Aged Care website. Providers are now able to see the expected waiting period for clients who are waiting for an upgrade.

Community Visitors Scheme (CVS):

CVS matches volunteers with older people who are socially isolated, for the purpose of friendship and companionship. The project continues to provide social support to CALD residents of Aged care facilities and to those living at home in receipt of Home Care Packages in the Hunter and Central Coast.

The CVS program is becoming more recognised and valued by service providers and members of diverse communities. This is reflected in the increase of referrals.

The number of Home Care Package Recipients on the Central Coast has doubled during the latter part of reporting period.

In the Hunter volunteers visited 35 clients, making 946 visits and travelling 12,951 kms.

Clients come from 14 different backgrounds – Italian, Ukrainian, Chinese, German, Dutch, Latvian, Australian, Russian, Indonesian, Polish, Macedonian, Spanish, Serbian and Czech and Vietnamese.

The commitment and dedication of our group of volunteers is invaluable. Our Community Visitors volunteers

meet several times a year for training, interaction and sharing information.

Commonwealth Home Support Programme:

Sector Support and Development (SSDO) - Multicultural Access Project Hunter

The Hunter CALD Elder Abuse Prevention Network (HCEAPN) campaign concluded in February 2018 with a "train the trainer" training delivered to members and leaders of different cultural communities and CALD Age Care service providers in Newcastle.

The report from the Hunter CALD Elder Abuse Prevention Campaign was launched in June 2018 at the World Elder Abuse Awareness Day event.

The SSDO presented an abstract on elder abuse awareness work at the FECCA National Biennial Conference in Darwin and the 5th National Elder Abuse conference in Sydney earlier this year. The SSDO also wrote an article for FECCA newsletter on elder abuse issues and took part in an interview hosted by the Senior Rights Australia.

NSS received funding from Settlement Services International (SSI) under the Future Ability Project (FA) to engage with and increase participation to the National Disability Insurance Scheme (NDIS) by CALD communities on the NDIS. A very successful Round Table event was held in November 2017 with 59 registered people attending.

As part of this project the SSDO facilitated delivery of NDIS information sessions by bi-lingual project workers to three different language communities: Hindi, Arabic and Kirundi.

The Arabic speaking bi-lingual project worker presented a paper about their communities' perspective at the DiversAbility/NDISinclusion Conference in April 2017.

Multicultural Social Support Programme - Hunter and Central Coast

This programme aims to reduce isolation and support social connectedness for those wishing to continue living quality and independent lives in their own homes. The programme focus is on wellness and reablement.

In the Hunter the program is supporting 6 ethno-specific communities including: Chinese, Spanish speaking, Vietnamese, Filipino, Tongan and Samoan.

The Central Coast supported over 110 clients with the assistance of 25 volunteers. Volunteers assist with transporting clients to appointments, shopping or attending social groups.

Social groups include Spanish speaking and 3 multicultural groups who meet at Bateau Bay, Woy Woy and Kanwal.

Information sessions are popular across both regions. Speakers were sourced from Legal Aid, Lawyers, Health Department, Immigration, Dementia Australia and Elder Abuse.

Festivals and cultural traditions are celebrated within each community such as Chinese New Year and ethno specific Independence Days. Shared events such as Harmony Day, Seniors Week, Carers Week and Mother's Day are a good opportunity for making friendships and community engagement opportunities.

Multicultural Flexible In Home Respite (MFIRS)

NSS was successful in gaining Commonwealth Home Support Program (CHSP) Growth funding to establish a Multicultural Flexible In-home Respite Service (MFIRS) in the Hunter and Central Coast regions. This innovative service provides flexible respite care to CALD carers who support frail aged or have a disability, in their own home to enable carers to have time out and energy to care for themselves.

The MFIRS Hunter service was established and operational in August 2017 and the Central Coast service commenced in December 2017.

The nature of the respite service is that it will be required for a short or a long period of time dependent on the needs of the Carer and Care Recipient. Services may be assistance with personal care, medication monitoring, meal preparation, transport to attend appointments and social support by appropriately qualified care support staff.

Carer CALD backgrounds have included Croatian, Polish, Greek, Ukrainian, Korean, Filipino, Fijian, German, Macedonian, Italian, Russian, Indian, Swiss, Lithuanian, Samoan and Dutch.

This program has been well received and MFIRS now offers planned overnight respite services and longer weekend services to continue supporting the carer with optimising respite opportunities.

MULTICULTURAL FAMILY SUPPORT & WELFARE



Welfare Team



Petrona Kelly
Welfare Team Manager /
Complex Case



Miza Torlakovic
CALD Family Worker
(Families First)



Juanita Loli
*Multicultural Family Support &
Welfare Coordinator, Tax Help,
EAPA Officer*



Zeni Edmunds
Brighter Futures Coordinator



Eleni Ferguson
*Multicultural Family Support &
Welfare Coordinator*

Pet Kelly – Team Manager

Multicultural Family Support & Welfare

The Welfare Team delivers the Early Intervention & Placement Prevention Program (EIPP), the CALD Family Support Project and the Brighter Futures Program - CALD Home Visitor program

The Early Intervention & Placement Prevention Program operates predominantly in Newcastle, Lake Macquarie with outreach services provided to locations across the Lower Hunter as capacity allows at Maitland, Cessnock & Port Stephens. This program targets low to medium risk children, young people and families from CALD backgrounds for short term support to identified issues & prevent escalation of problems. The support service model is structured to deliver 2 streams of service provision:

- Child & Family Support targets families with children aged 0 – 12 years or expecting a child
- Youth & Family Support targets young people 13 to under 18 years or families with young people in this age range

The CALD Family Support provides support to vulnerable disadvantaged families comprising of first time parents and families with children aged 0-8 from CALD backgrounds. The target group includes teenage parents and parents with a developmentally disability and/or parents with special needs who live in the Newcastle and Lake Macquarie LGAs.

Key Service Specifications of these Projects include:

- Advice & Referrals by providing comprehensive information and advice to young people & families

- Assessment & Case Planning by providing assessment to assess the strengths and needs, including any risks; plan and coordinate a mix of services to meet the needs of client/clients
- Home visits, delivered to individual family home or another location
- Parents Support Groups by facilitating self-help/peer support groups for parents

The Brighter Futures Program provides intensive and preventative support to vulnerable families with young children, where children are identified at risk of significant harm. Parenting support is offered through regular home visits to ensure any family issues are addressed immediately. The program is voluntary & takes referrals from Family & Community Services (FACS). Samaritans Foundation is the lead agency & NSS provides the home visiting component of the program to CALD families. Families who qualify for the program are experiencing domestic violence, drugs & alcohol problems & when one or both parents suffer from mental illness.

Highlights and Achievements

Group Sessions

- 250 group sessions were held with 5,004 individuals and families attending.

Case Management

This year, the Welfare Team provided 350 instances of support to individuals and families:

- Presenting issues were inter-related and on many occasions a client/family presented a number of needs or problems including domestic violence,

immigration, homelessness, financial, mental health, legal/court matters, health, social/emotional, unemployment, family problems, material needs, education & training, tenancy, youth issues, housing & accommodation, child protection, etc.

- Individuals & families were assisted according to needs. Support was provided through outreach either face to face and through other means such as e-mails, text, phone calls, etc.
- Clients were provided information, options, & advice relevant to their needs & referred to culturally appropriate services either external or to NSS workers
- Children with child protection issues reduced and young people's level of safety and well-being improved
- Social isolation and homesickness among the women has been reduced; a sense of belonging, camaraderie and self-esteem increased through participating in group activities
- Eight clients of CALD backgrounds gained Drivers' License

Multicultural Playgroups/Parenting

In partnership with other organisations, the Welfare Team is heavily involved in supporting Multicultural playgroups at various locations such as:

- MOMS (Mothers ' Obstetrics Multicultural Support in partnership with

Hunter New England Multicultural Health Services being run at Hunter Multicultural Communities in Waratah

- NSS Multicultural Parenting Group, Waratah
- Multicultural Supported Playgroup with Kindergarten Union (KU), Mission Australia and Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre (MNC) held at MNC, Lambton
- NSS Multicultural Playtime Group in partnership with MNC at Lambton
- Russian Bicultural Children's Group being run in Wallsend



- Multicultural Playgroup in collaboration with Lake Macquarie City Council & The Willows, Warners Bay
- Afghan Women's Social Group, Jesmond Neighbourhood Centre



Participation in Events:

The team participated in:

- Harmony Day Celebrations in Lake Macquarie, Cessnock, Singleton & Hamilton
- White Ribbon Breakfast Newcastle
- Multicultural Expo, Multicultural Neighbourhood Centre in Lambton
- Refugee Week Celebrations
- “Play, Outside Play”, Wetlands Shortland
- Lake Macquarie Family Exhibition, “You’re Kidding Me Expo” at Glendale

Indeed, it has been another very hectic year for the team, but a satisfying one. It is a pleasure leading the Welfare Team for their continued hard work and cooperation which creates such a wonderful working environment. Warm thanks go to each and every one of them.



NSS WORKERS LYDIA AND ELENA PARTICIPATING AT OUTSIDE PLAY FOR FAMILIES



NORTHLAKES MULTICULTURAL PLAYTIME



MOMS FRIENDSHIP GROUP

IMMIGRATION ADVICE & ASSISTANCE



Immigration Advice & Assistance



This last year has been busy as there have been a large number of Syrian refugees arriving in the Hunter region. Understandably many of the Syrian people who were resettled here have family members still in Syria and other countries such as Lebanon and Turkey. These family members are often in dire circumstances and also need a safe place. Unfortunately all of the applications lodged by family members were refused by the Department of Home Affairs. This has been a cause of stress for many people.

Four years ago the Hunter region saw a large number of families coming from Afghanistan on humanitarian visas. This is not a common practice as usually people need to be outside of their country of origin to be granted a humanitarian visa. However the men in these families were working for the Allied Forces as interpreters. Because of their work they and their families were very much at risk and so the decision was made to grant them visas and relocate them to Australia. Now these families are eligible to apply for citizenship as they have been here for four years. We have been very busy applying for citizenship for the majority. They have settled in well and want to complete their integration into Australian life by becoming citizens and therefore "Aussies".

While the majority of clients are from refugee backgrounds we also work with migrant and Australian born people on a range of issues. Applications for citizenship and for visitor visas are common. However the

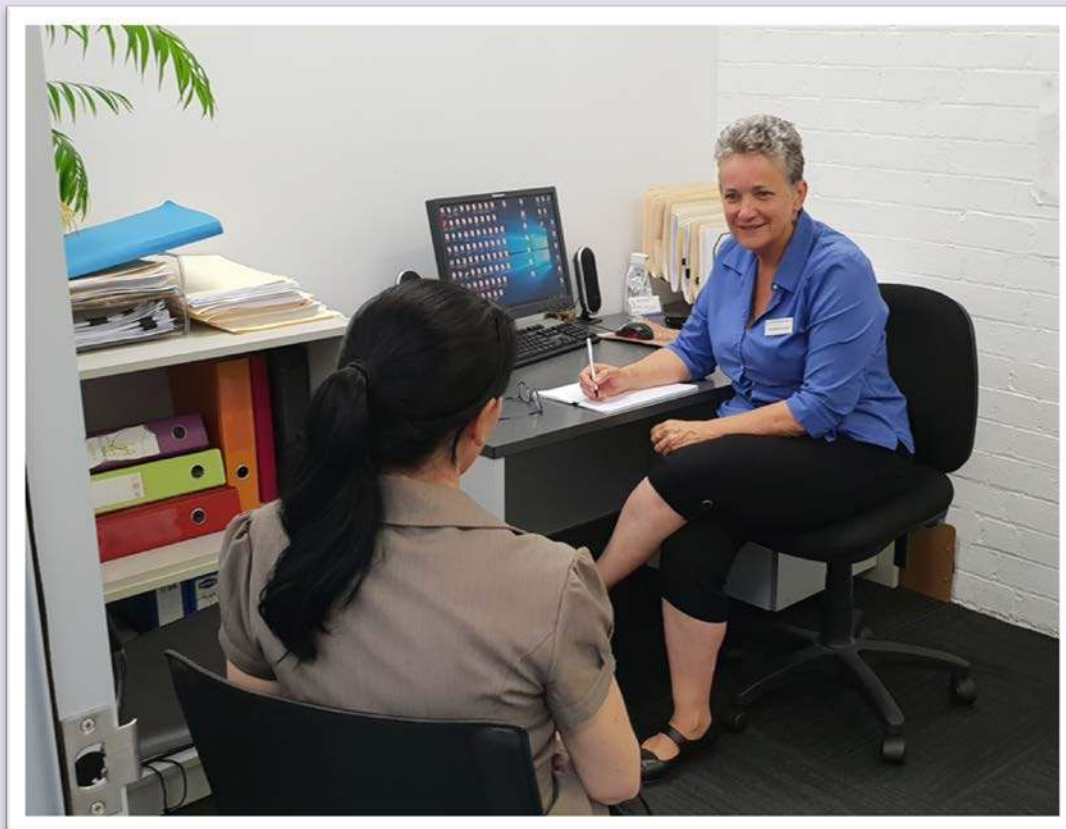
bulk of the work is for partner visas. Nowadays we are a globetrotting nation and inevitably falling in love overseas happens. Applying for partner visas can be complex and it is important that it is done correctly. Therefore people come to the service for assistance. The visa cost for a partner visa is also quite high and non-refundable if refused.

Unfortunately sometimes relationships end for a variety of reasons. It is very stressful to move to another country and culture within a new relationship. Some people choose to leave the relationship and return home. Others are forced into leaving due to family violence. There are provisions under immigration law which enable some visa holders to apply for permanency in Australia despite the relationship having ended. This is also a group whom we assist.

We have given talks at different groups such as the Afghan Women's Group, for staff and for students at the University. We are happy to provide this service free.

Currently there are long delays in both the Department of Home Affairs and at the Administrative Appeals Tribunal in decision making. We try to assist clients as quickly as possible however we cannot influence the speed of the process. This creates frustration for both clients and workers.

While NSS helps many clients without cost we do have to ask for payment in some cases. This enables us to continue providing the service.



HENRIETTE PROVIDING INFORMATION



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NSS ADMINISTRATION TEAM



Katie Sewell
Operations Manager



Kerry Blades
Finance Manager



Kathy Rowarth
Accounts



John Pattey
*Senior Administration
Officer*



Natasha Holliday
Administration Officer



Violeta Klements
Administration Officer



Sharlene Huber
*Administration /
Finance Officer
Central Coast*



Julie Mills
*Administration Officer
Central Coast*

NSS SNAPSHOTS OF 2017/18

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NSS STAFF MEMBER TONKOH - HARMONY DAY



MULTICULTURAL HEALTH WEEK



MULTICULTURAL PARENTING GROUP



RIVERLIGHTS MULTICULTURAL FESTIVAL



AFRICA DAY CELEBRATIONS



HARMONY DAY GREGSON PARK HAMILTON



HARMONY DAY GREGSON PARK HAMILTON



HARMONY DAY GREGSON PARK HAMILTON



AUSTRALIA'S BIGGEST MORNING TEA - CENTRAL COAST



MULTICULTURAL SENIORS WEEK





CALD ELDER ABUSE WORKSHOP



AFRICA DAY CELEBRATIONS



CALD ELDER ABUSE WORKSHOP



MULTICULTURAL COMMUNITY LIAISON OFFICER PATRICIA OWEN WITH
SETTLEMENT WORKER ROSE OKU AT RIVERLIGHTS MULTICULTURAL FESTIVAL



VOLUNTEER WEEK



MULTICULTURAL HEALTH WEEK



WORLD SUICIDE PREVENTION DAY WALK



YOUTH CULTURAL EXCHANGE



UNITY IN DIVERSITY

FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

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Northern Settlement Services Limited

ABN 72 002 898 759

Annual Report - 30 June 2018

Northern Settlement Services Limited

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30 June 2018

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Northern Settlement Services Limited
Responsible entities' report
30 June 2018

The responsible entities present their report, together with the financial statements, on the company for the year ended 30 June 2018.

Responsible entities

The following persons were responsible entities of the company during the whole of the financial year and up to the date of this report, unless otherwise stated:

Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers
 Zoran Vasiljevic
 Sania Young
 Fr Nicholas Zervas
 Christine Jordan
 Anna Marendy (resigned 20 September 2017)
 Jon Chin
 Ewa Korczynski
 Zachary Ekandi
 Anna Bailey (appointed 16 November 2017)

Principal activities

During the financial year the principal continuing activities of the company consisted of:

- providing welfare and information services.

Short and long term objectives

Northern Settlement Services has developed a strategic plan with objectives, strategies and indicators to guide and monitor the work of the organisation. The short and long term objectives are achieved through leadership, support and advocacy of clients, and reviewed at each Board meeting using financial and non financial key performance indicators. In this way, the organisation can continue to develop programs and activities across settlement areas that are responsive to client needs.

Operating result

The surplus of the company for the financial year amounted to \$536,192 (2017: \$76,673).

Information on responsible entities

Name:	Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers
Experience and expertise:	Retired - Director Hunter Health - Migrant Health Unit - Regional Co-ordinator NSW Ethnic Affairs Commission - Nurse Counsellor - Working Women's Centre - Board Member of Tinonee Gardens Multicultural Village
Special responsibilities:	Director, Chairperson, Public Officer, Audit Committee
Name:	Zoran Vasiljevic
Experience and expertise:	Practicing Solicitor - Over 15 year solicitor in Australia - 14 years lawyer/solicitor in Yugoslavia - Bosnian Community Representative
Special responsibilities:	Director
Name:	Sania Young
Experience and expertise:	Extensive aged care experience - enrolled nurse - Diploma in Community Development - Diploma in Social Science - Diploma of Librarian - Tartar Community Representative
Special responsibilities:	Director

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Responsible entities' report
30 June 2018

Name:	Fr Nicholas Zervas
Experience and expertise:	Priest of the Greek Community of Newcastle since 1973 - Life member of Ethnic Communities Council of Newcastle and Hunter - Greek Community Representative - Meals on Wheels - Volunteer 21 years - Fronditha Aged Care Nursing Home - Life member
Special responsibilities:	Director
Name:	Christine Jordan
Experience and expertise:	Retired - Bachelor of Social Services - Over 20 years in Child Protection - Juvenile Justice - Nursing - General/Psych, Aged and Disability - Resettlement Office for Newly Arrived Migrants (Red Cross) - Polish Community Representative
Special responsibilities:	Director, Audit Committee
Name:	Anna Marendy (resigned 20 September 2017)
Experience and expertise:	Retired - Founding member and life member of Fronditha Aged Care Nursing Home - Greek Community Representative - Over 25 years volunteer with Hippocrates Assoc.
Special responsibilities:	Director
Name:	Jon Chin
Experience and expertise:	Local Businessman - Extensive experience working with Board in the Club industry
Special responsibilities:	Director, Vice Chair
Name:	Anna Bailey
Experience and expertise:	- Senior Law Associate - Bachelor of Laws and Bachelor of Arts, postgraduate at the College of Law - Graduate of the Australian Institute of Company Directors - Committee member of Newcastle Business Club - Member of Law society NSW, Gen Collective and Hunter Women's Business Network.
Special responsibilities:	Director
Name:	Ewa Korczynski
Experience and expertise:	- Community Options Unit Service Director - Hunter New England Health for over 20 years - Bachelor of Applied Science - Hon.; Grad. Diploma of Welfare Law - Volunteer crew member o James Craig the tall ship (Sydney Maritime Museum) and volunteer with Dog Rescue Newcastle
Special responsibilities:	Director, Secretary, Audit Committee
Name:	Zachary Ekandi
Experience and expertise:	TAFE Services Coordinator - Advisory Council Member - Regional Advisory Council Multicultural NSW - Advisory Committee Member - Multicultural Advisory Committee NSW Police Force - Advisory Committee Member - Multicultural Advisory Committee Wyong Shire Council - Accredited Interpreter NAATI - SEO - IMEC at Hunter TAFE NSW Online/Remote Information Technology Officer - IT Support Officer Students Union - University of Newcastle
Special responsibilities:	Director, Treasurer

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Responsible entities' report
30 June 2018

Company secretary

The following person held the position of company secretary at the end of the financial year:

Ewa Korczynski was appointed Company Secretary on 16 November 2017.

Meetings of responsible entities

The number of meetings of the company's Board of Directors ('the Board') held during the year ended 30 June 2018, and the number of meetings attended by each responsible entity were:

	Full Board Attended	Held
Geertrude Maria Wilhemina Mills-Evers	7	9
Zoran Vasiljevic	6	9
Sania Young	9	9
Fr Nicholas Zervas	5	9
Christine Jordan	7	9
Anna Marendy (resigned 20 September 2017)	-	4
Jon Chin	7	9
Ewa Korczynski	8	9
Zachary Ekandi	7	9
Anna Bailey (appointed 16 November 2017)	3	6

Held: represents the number of meetings held during the time the responsible entity held office.

Indemnifying officer or auditor

During the year, the company effected a directors and officers liability policy. The insurance policy provides cover for the directors named in this report, the company secretary, officers and former directors and officers of the company. This policy prohibits the disclosure of the nature of the indemnification, the insurance cover and the amount of the premium.

No indemnities have been given or insurance premiums paid, during or since the end of the financial year, for any person who is or has been an auditor of the company.

Contributions on winding up

In the event of the company being wound up, ordinary members are required to contribute a maximum of \$10 each.

The total amount that members of the company are liable to contribute if the company is wound up is \$380, based on 38 current ordinary members (2017: 38).

Auditor's independence declaration

A copy of the auditor's independence declaration is set out immediately after this directors' report.

This report is made in accordance with a resolution of the directors.

On behalf of the responsible entities



Jon Chin
Vice Chair

17 October 2018

Unit 1, 1 Pioneer Avenue
PO Box 3399
Tuggerah NSW 2259

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INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S DECLARATION TO THE MEMBERS OF NORTHERN SETTLEMENT SERVICES LIMITED

We hereby declare that to the best of our knowledge and belief during the year ended 30 June 2018, there have been:

- (i) no contraventions of the auditor independence requirements as set out in the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012* in relation to the audit; and
- (ii) no contraventions of any applicable code of professional conduct in relation to the audit.

Name of Firm

Bishop Collins Audit Pty Ltd
Chartered Accountants

Name of Registered Company Auditor


Martin Le Marchant

Auditor's Registration No.

431227

Address

Unit 1, 1 Pioneer Avenue, Tuggerah NSW 2259

Dated

17 October 2018



LIABILITY LIMITED BY A SCHEME APPROVED UNDER THE PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS LEGISLATION



Registered Company Auditors:

Glenn A Harris CA

Martin Le Marchant CA

Unit 1, 1 Pioneer Avenue
PO Box 3399
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**INDEPENDENT AUDITOR'S REPORT
TO THE MEMBERS OF NORTHERN SETTLEMENT SERVICES LIMITED**

Audit Opinion

We have audited the accompanying financial report of Northern Settlement Services Limited ('the Company') which comprises the statement of financial position as at 30 June 2018, statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income, statement of changes in equity and statement of cash flows for the year ended on that date, notes comprising a summary of significant accounting policies and other explanatory information and the Responsible Entities' Declaration.

In our opinion the accompanying financial report of Northern Settlement Services Limited is in accordance with the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012*, including:

- (i) giving a true and fair view of the Company's financial position as at 30 June 2018 and of its performance for the year ended on that date; and
- (ii) complying with Australian Accounting Standards – Reduced Disclosure Requirements (including the Australian Accounting Interpretations) and the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Regulation 2013*.

Basis for Opinion

We conducted our audit in accordance with Australian Auditing Standards. Our responsibilities under those standards are further described in the *Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Report* section of our report. We are independent of the Company in accordance with the ethical requirements of the Accounting Professional and Ethical Standards Board's APES 110 Code of Ethics for Professional Accountants (the Code) that are relevant to our audit of the financial report in Australia. We also fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with the Code.

We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.

Responsible Entities' Responsibilities for the Financial Report

The Responsible Entities ('Directors') of the Company are responsible for the preparation of the financial report that gives a true and fair view in accordance with Australian Accounting Standards – Reduced Disclosure Requirements and the *Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012*, and for such internal control as the Directors determine is necessary to enable the preparation of the financial report that gives a true and fair view and is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error.

In preparing the financial report, the Directors are responsible for assessing the Company's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters related to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting unless the Directors either intend to liquidate the Company or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so.



CHARTERED ACCOUNTANTS
(AUSTRALIAN ACCOUNTS)

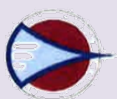
LIABILITY LIMITED BY A SCHEME APPROVED UNDER THE PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS LEGISLATION



Registered Company Auditors:

Glenn A Harris CA

Martin Le Marchant CA



Auditor's Responsibilities for the Audit of the Financial Report

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial report as a whole is free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with the Australian Auditing Standards will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error and are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of this financial report.

As part of an audit in accordance with the Australian Auditing Standards, we exercise professional judgement and maintain professional scepticism throughout the audit. We also:

- Identify and assess the risks of material misstatement of the financial report, whether due to fraud or error, design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks, and obtain audit evidence that is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion. The risk of not detecting a material misstatement resulting from fraud is higher than for one resulting from error, as fraud may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal control.
- Obtain an understanding of internal control relevant to the audit in order to design audit procedures that are appropriate in the circumstances, but not for the purpose of expressing an opinion on the effectiveness of the Company's internal control.
- Evaluate the appropriateness of accounting policies used and the reasonableness of accounting estimates and related disclosures made by the Directors.
- Conclude on the appropriateness of the Directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting in the preparation of the financial report. We also conclude, based on the audit evidence obtained, whether a material uncertainty exists related to events or conditions that may cast significant doubt on the Company's ability to continue as a going concern. If we conclude that a material uncertainty exists, we are required to draw attention in our auditor's report to the disclosures in the financial report about the material uncertainty or, if such disclosures are inadequate, to modify the opinion on the financial report. Our conclusions are based on the audit evidence obtained up to the date of our auditor's report. However, future events or conditions may cause the Company to cease to continue as a going concern.
- Evaluate the overall presentation, structure and content of the financial report, including the disclosures, and whether the financial report represents the underlying transactions and events in a manner that achieves fair presentation.

We communicate with the Directors regarding, among other matters, the planned scope and timing of the audit and significant audit findings, including any significant deficiencies in internal control that we identify during our audit.

We also provide the Directors with a statement that we have complied with relevant ethical requirements regarding independence, and to communicate with them all relationships and other matters that may reasonably be thought to bear on our independence, and where applicable, related safeguards.

Name of Firm	Bishop Collins Audit Pty Ltd Chartered Accountants
Name of Registered Company Auditor	 Martin Le Marchant
Auditor's Registration No.	431227
Address	Unit 1, 1 Pioneer Avenue, Tuggerah NSW 2259
Dated	17 October 2018

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income
For the year ended 30 June 2018

	Note	2018 \$	2017 \$
Revenue	4	3,936,289	3,108,509
Other income	5	33,598	29,647
Expenses			
Advertising expenses		(2,785)	(8,645)
Auditor's remuneration		(16,000)	(14,950)
Computer expenses		(25,840)	(15,082)
Depreciation and amortisation expense		(85,987)	(92,134)
Employee benefits expense		(2,460,208)	(2,144,469)
Facilities and cleaning expenses		(32,209)	(42,686)
Insurance expenses		(13,838)	(17,363)
Motor vehicle expenses		(5,203)	(5,191)
Printing, postage and stationery expenses		(23,313)	(23,069)
Program expenses		(145,585)	(159,834)
Office expenses		(14,329)	(16,847)
Service expenses		(452,197)	(389,106)
Subscriptions and membership expenses		(4,709)	(4,986)
Training and travelling expenses		(32,919)	(28,672)
Utilities expense		(36,893)	(33,278)
Volunteer expenses		(32,755)	(40,236)
Workers compensation expenses		(48,917)	(24,319)
Bank fees		(8)	(616)
Surplus before income tax expense		536,192	76,673
Income tax expense		-	-
Surplus after income tax expense for the year	15	536,192	76,673
Other comprehensive income for the year, net of tax		-	-
Total comprehensive income for the year		<u>536,192</u>	<u>76,673</u>

The above statement of profit or loss and other comprehensive income should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Statement of financial position
As at 30 June 2018

	Note	2018	2017
		\$	\$
Assets			
Current assets			
Cash and cash equivalents	6	3,144,893	2,363,427
Trade and other receivables	7	74,318	58,165
Held-to-maturity investments	8	858,067	840,533
Other current assets	9	376	20,274
Total current assets		<u>4,077,654</u>	<u>3,282,399</u>
Non-current assets			
Property, plant and equipment	10	968,121	1,054,108
Total non-current assets		<u>968,121</u>	<u>1,054,108</u>
Total assets		<u>5,045,775</u>	<u>4,336,507</u>
Liabilities			
Current liabilities			
Trade and other payables	11	198,426	187,559
Employee benefits	12	406,399	327,006
Other current liabilities	13	832,014	732,104
Total current liabilities		<u>1,436,839</u>	<u>1,246,669</u>
Non-current liabilities			
Employee benefits	14	33,062	50,156
Total non-current liabilities		<u>33,062</u>	<u>50,156</u>
Total liabilities		<u>1,469,901</u>	<u>1,296,825</u>
Net assets		<u>3,575,874</u>	<u>3,039,682</u>
Equity			
Retained surpluses	15	3,575,874	3,039,682
Total equity		<u>3,575,874</u>	<u>3,039,682</u>

The above statement of financial position should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Statement of changes in equity
For the year ended 30 June 2018

	Retained surpluses \$	Total equity \$
Balance at 1 July 2016	2,963,009	2,963,009
Surplus after income tax expense for the year	76,673	76,673
Other comprehensive income for the year, net of tax	-	-
Total comprehensive income for the year	<u>76,673</u>	<u>76,673</u>
Balance at 30 June 2017	<u>3,039,682</u>	<u>3,039,682</u>
	Retained surpluses \$	Total equity \$
Balance at 1 July 2017	3,039,682	3,039,682
Surplus after income tax expense for the year	536,192	536,192
Other comprehensive income for the year, net of tax	-	-
Total comprehensive income for the year	<u>536,192</u>	<u>536,192</u>
Balance at 30 June 2018	<u>3,575,874</u>	<u>3,575,874</u>

The above statement of changes in equity should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Statement of cash flows
For the year ended 30 June 2018

	Note	2018	2017
		\$	\$
Cash flows from operating activities			
Receipts from customers (inclusive of GST)		4,342,510	4,133,524
Payments to suppliers (inclusive of GST)		(3,577,108)	(3,178,705)
		<u>765,402</u>	<u>954,819</u>
Interest received		33,598	29,647
		<u>799,000</u>	<u>984,466</u>
Net cash from operating activities			
Cash flows from investing activities			
Payments for investments		(17,534)	(310,879)
Payments for property, plant and equipment		-	(22,344)
		<u>(17,534)</u>	<u>(333,223)</u>
Net cash used in investing activities			
Cash flows from financing activities			
Net cash from financing activities		-	-
Net increase in cash and cash equivalents		<u>781,466</u>	<u>651,243</u>
Cash and cash equivalents at the beginning of the financial year		2,363,427	1,712,184
Cash and cash equivalents at the end of the financial year	6	<u><u>3,144,893</u></u>	<u><u>2,363,427</u></u>

The above statement of cash flows should be read in conjunction with the accompanying notes

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2018

Note 1. General information

The financial statements cover Northern Settlement Services Limited as an individual entity which is incorporated and domiciled in Australia. The financial statements are presented in Australian dollars, which is Northern Settlement Services Limited's functional and presentation currency.

Northern Settlement Services Limited is a not-for-profit unlisted public company limited by guarantee.

The financial statements were authorised for issue, in accordance with a resolution of responsible entities, on 17 October 2018.

Note 2. Significant accounting policies

The principal accounting policies adopted in the preparation of the financial statements are set out below. These policies have been consistently applied to all the years presented, unless otherwise stated.

New or amended Accounting Standards and Interpretations adopted

The company has adopted all of the new or amended Accounting Standards and Interpretations issued by the Australian Accounting Standards Board ('AASB') that are mandatory for the current reporting period.

New or amended Accounting standards and interpretations not yet adopted

The AASB has issued new and amended accounting standards and interpretations that have mandatory application dates from 1 January 2019 and will be applicable in the 2019 financial year. The Company has not opted for early adoption of these standards.

AASB 16 Leases – The revised standard removes the distinction between operating and finance leases for leases. The standard requires rights and obligations relating to most leases to be recognised on the balance sheet. The Company has not yet considered the impact of all leases and agreements currently in place.

AASB 15 Revenue from Contracts with Customers – This standard moves the revenue recognition focus from transaction level to a contractual rights and obligations basis. The Company has not yet considered the impact of this standard.

AASB 1058 Income for Not for Profits – This standard primarily applies to income not accounted for under AASB 115. This standard establishes principles applying to transactions where the consideration to acquire an asset is significantly less than fair value principally to enable a not-for-profit entity to further its objectives and the receipt of volunteer services. The changes in revenue recognition requirements in AASB 1058 may cause changes to the timing and amount of income recorded in the financial statements as well as additional disclosures. This includes contributions of assets at less than fair value, peppercorn leases and volunteer services.

Any new or amended Accounting Standards or Interpretations that are not yet mandatory have not been early adopted.

Basis of preparation

These general purpose financial statements have been prepared in accordance with Australian Accounting Standards - Reduced Disclosure Requirements and Interpretations issued by the Australian Accounting Standards Board ('AASB') and the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012.

Historical cost convention

The financial statements have been prepared under the historical cost convention, except for, where applicable, the revaluation of available-for-sale financial assets, financial assets and liabilities at fair value through profit or loss, investment properties, certain classes of property, plant and equipment and derivative financial instruments.

Critical accounting estimates

The preparation of the financial statements requires the use of certain critical accounting estimates. It also requires management to exercise its judgement in the process of applying the company's accounting policies. The areas involving a higher degree of judgement or complexity, or areas where assumptions and estimates are significant to the financial statements, are disclosed in note 3.

Note 2. Significant accounting policies (continued)

Revenue recognition

Revenue is recognised when it is probable that the economic benefit will flow to the company and the revenue can be reliably measured. Revenue is measured at the fair value of the consideration received or receivable.

Rendering of services

Stage of completion is measured by reference to hours incurred to date as a percentage of total estimated hours for each contract. Where the contract outcome cannot be reliably estimated, revenue is only recognised to the extent of the recoverable costs incurred to date.

Grants

A number of the Company's programs are supported by grants received from the federal, state and local governments. If conditions are attached to a grant which must be satisfied before the Company is eligible to receive the contribution, recognition of the grant as revenue is deferred until those conditions are satisfied. Where a grant is received on the condition that specified services are delivered, to the grantor, this is considered a reciprocal transaction. Revenue is recognised as services are performed and at year-end until the service is delivered. Revenue from a non-reciprocal grant that is not subject to conditions is recognised when the Company obtains control of the funds, economic benefits are probable and the amount can be measured reliably. Where a grant may be required to be repaid if certain conditions are not satisfied, a liability is recognised at year end to the extent that conditions remain unsatisfied. Where the company receives a non-reciprocal contribution of an asset from a government or other party for no or nominal consideration, the asset is recognised at fair value and a corresponding amount of revenue is recognised.

Interest

Interest revenue is recognised as interest accrues using the effective interest method. This is a method of calculating the amortised cost of a financial asset and allocating the interest income over the relevant period using the effective interest rate, which is the rate that exactly discounts estimated future cash receipts through the expected life of the financial asset to the net carrying amount of the financial asset.

Rent

Rent revenue is recognised on a straight-line basis over the lease term.

Other revenue

Other revenue is recognised when it is received or when the right to receive payment is established.

Income tax

As the company is a tax exempt institution in terms of subsection 50-10 of the Income Tax Assessment Act 1997, as amended, it is exempt from paying income tax.

Current and non-current classification

Assets and liabilities are presented in the statement of financial position based on current and non-current classification.

An asset is classified as current when: it is either expected to be realised or intended to be sold or consumed in the company's normal operating cycle; it is held primarily for the purpose of trading; it is expected to be realised within 12 months after the reporting period; or the asset is cash or cash equivalent unless restricted from being exchanged or used to settle a liability for at least 12 months after the reporting period. All other assets are classified as non-current.

A liability is classified as current when: it is either expected to be settled in the company's normal operating cycle; it is held primarily for the purpose of trading; it is due to be settled within 12 months after the reporting period; or there is no unconditional right to defer the settlement of the liability for at least 12 months after the reporting period. All other liabilities are classified as non-current.

Cash and cash equivalents

Cash and cash equivalents includes cash on hand, deposits held at call with financial institutions, other short-term, highly liquid investments with original maturities of three months or less that are readily convertible to known amounts of cash and which are subject to an insignificant risk of changes in value.

Trade and other receivables

Trade receivables are initially recognised at fair value and subsequently measured at amortised cost using the effective interest method, less any provision for impairment. Trade receivables are generally due for settlement within 30 days.

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2018

Note 2. Significant accounting policies (continued)

Collectability of trade receivables is reviewed on an ongoing basis. Debts which are known to be uncollectable are written off by reducing the carrying amount directly. A provision for impairment of trade receivables is raised when there is objective evidence that the company will not be able to collect all amounts due according to the original terms of the receivables. Significant financial difficulties of the debtor, probability that the debtor will enter bankruptcy or financial reorganisation and default or delinquency in payments (more than 60 days overdue) are considered indicators that the trade receivable may be impaired. The amount of the impairment allowance is the difference between the asset's carrying amount and the present value of estimated future cash flows, discounted at the original effective interest rate. Cash flows relating to short-term receivables are not discounted if the effect of discounting is immaterial.

Other receivables are recognised at amortised cost, less any provision for impairment.

Investments and other financial assets

Investments and other financial assets are initially measured at fair value. Transaction costs are included as part of the initial measurement, except for financial assets at fair value through profit or loss. They are subsequently measured at either amortised cost or fair value depending on their classification. Classification is determined based on the purpose of the acquisition and subsequent reclassification to other categories is restricted.

Financial assets are derecognised when the rights to receive cash flows from the financial assets have expired or have been transferred and the company has transferred substantially all the risks and rewards of ownership.

Held-to-maturity investments

Held-to-maturity investments includes non-derivative financial assets with fixed or determinable payments and fixed maturities where the company has the positive intention and ability to hold the financial asset to maturity. This category excludes financial assets that are held for an undefined period. Held-to-maturity investments are carried at amortised cost using the effective interest rate method adjusted for any principal repayments. Gains and losses are recognised in profit or loss when the asset is derecognised or impaired.

Impairment of financial assets

The company assesses at the end of each reporting period whether there is any objective evidence that a financial asset or group of financial assets is impaired. Objective evidence includes significant financial difficulty of the issuer or obligor; a breach of contract such as default or delinquency in payments; the lender granting to a borrower concessions due to economic or legal reasons that the lender would not otherwise do; it becomes probable that the borrower will enter bankruptcy or other financial reorganisation; the disappearance of an active market for the financial asset; or observable data indicating that there is a measurable decrease in estimated future cash flows.

Property, plant and equipment

Land and Buildings are measured at cost. Buildings are measured at cost less accumulated depreciation and impairment losses.

Plant and equipment is stated at historical cost less accumulated depreciation and impairment. Historical cost includes expenditure that is directly attributable to the acquisition of the items.

Depreciation is calculated on a straight-line basis to write off the net cost of each item of property, plant and equipment (excluding land) over their expected useful lives as follows:

Buildings	40 years
Leasehold improvements	3-10 years
Plant and equipment	4-10 years
Motor vehicles	2-5 years

The residual values, useful lives and depreciation methods are reviewed, and adjusted if appropriate, at each reporting date.

Leasehold improvements and plant and equipment under lease are depreciated over the unexpired period of the lease or the estimated useful life of the assets, whichever is shorter.

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2018

Note 2. Significant accounting policies (continued)

An item of property, plant and equipment is derecognised upon disposal or when there is no future economic benefit to the company. Gains and losses between the carrying amount and the disposal proceeds are taken to profit or loss. Any revaluation surplus reserve relating to the item disposed of is transferred directly to retained profits.

Trade and other payables

These amounts represent liabilities for goods and services provided to the company prior to the end of the financial year and which are unpaid. Due to their short-term nature they are measured at amortised cost and are not discounted. The amounts are unsecured and are usually paid within 30 days of recognition.

Employee benefits

Short-term employee benefits

Liabilities for wages and salaries, including non-monetary benefits, annual leave and long service leave expected to be settled wholly within 12 months of the reporting date are measured at the amounts expected to be paid when the liabilities are settled.

Other long-term employee benefits

The liability for annual leave and long service leave not expected to be settled within 12 months of the reporting date are measured at the present value of expected future payments to be made in respect of services provided by employees up to the reporting date using the projected unit credit method. Consideration is given to expected future wage and salary levels, experience of employee departures and periods of service. Expected future payments are discounted using market yields at the reporting date on national government bonds with terms to maturity and currency that match, as closely as possible, the estimated future cash outflows.

Defined contribution superannuation expense

Contributions to defined contribution superannuation plans are expensed in the period in which they are incurred.

Goods and Services Tax ('GST') and other similar taxes

Revenues, expenses and assets are recognised net of the amount of associated GST, unless the GST incurred is not recoverable from the tax authority. In this case it is recognised as part of the cost of the acquisition of the asset or as part of the expense.

Receivables and payables are stated inclusive of the amount of GST receivable or payable. The net amount of GST recoverable from, or payable to, the tax authority is included in other receivables or other payables in the statement of financial position.

Cash flows are presented on a gross basis. The GST components of cash flows arising from investing or financing activities which are recoverable from, or payable to the tax authority, are presented as operating cash flows.

Economic Dependence

Northern Settlement Services Limited is dependent upon government departments for grant funding. At the date of this report, the directors have no reason to believe that the departments will not continue to support the company.

Note 3. Critical accounting judgements, estimates and assumptions

The preparation of the financial statements requires management to make judgements, estimates and assumptions that affect the reported amounts in the financial statements. Management continually evaluates its judgements and estimates in relation to assets, liabilities, contingent liabilities, revenue and expenses. Management bases its judgements, estimates and assumptions on historical experience and on other various factors, including expectations of future events, management believes to be reasonable under the circumstances. The resulting accounting judgements and estimates will seldom equal the related actual results. The judgements, estimates and assumptions that have a significant risk of causing a material adjustment to the carrying amounts of assets and liabilities (refer to the respective notes) within the next financial year are discussed below.

Provision for impairment of receivables

The provision for impairment of receivables assessment requires a degree of estimation and judgement. The level of provision is assessed by taking into account the recent sales experience, the ageing of receivables, historical collection rates and specific knowledge of the individual debtor's financial position.

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2018

Note 3. Critical accounting judgements, estimates and assumptions (continued)

Estimation of useful lives of assets

The company determines the estimated useful lives and related depreciation and amortisation charges for its property, plant and equipment and finite life intangible assets. The useful lives could change significantly as a result of technical innovations or some other event. The depreciation and amortisation charge will increase where the useful lives are less than previously estimated lives, or technically obsolete or non-strategic assets that have been abandoned or sold will be written off or written down.

Employee benefits provision

As discussed in note 2, the liability for employee benefits expected to be settled more than 12 months from the reporting date are recognised and measured at the present value of the estimated future cash flows to be made in respect of all employees at the reporting date. In determining the present value of the liability, estimates of attrition rates, pay increases through promotion and inflation, and probability factors have been taken into account.

Note 4. Revenue

	2018 \$	2017 \$
<i>Sales revenue</i>		
Grant funding received	2,973,434	2,494,098
Government subsidies received	860,138	448,730
Client contributions received	48,761	58,843
SSI hosting fees	21,305	59,192
Donations received	5,457	8,139
	<u>3,909,095</u>	<u>3,069,002</u>
<i>Other revenue</i>		
Immigration services	26,328	21,488
Other revenue	866	18,019
	<u>27,194</u>	<u>39,507</u>
Revenue	<u>3,936,289</u>	<u>3,108,509</u>

Note 5. Other income

	2018 \$	2017 \$
Interest received	<u>33,598</u>	<u>29,647</u>

Note 6. Current assets - cash and cash equivalents

	2018 \$	2017 \$
Cash on hand and at bank	<u>3,144,893</u>	<u>2,363,427</u>

Note 7. Current assets - trade and other receivables

	2018 \$	2017 \$
Trade receivables	73,658	57,935
Other receivables	660	230
	<u>74,318</u>	<u>58,165</u>

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2018

Note 8. Current assets - held-to-maturity investments

	2018	2017
	\$	\$
Term deposits	<u>858,067</u>	<u>840,533</u>

Note 9. Current assets - other current assets

	2018	2017
	\$	\$
Prepayments	<u>376</u>	<u>20,274</u>

Note 10. Non-current assets - property, plant and equipment

	2018	2017
	\$	\$
Land - at cost	<u>390,000</u>	<u>390,000</u>
Buildings - at cost	519,269	519,269
Less: Accumulated depreciation	<u>(163,975)</u>	<u>(143,204)</u>
	<u>355,294</u>	<u>376,065</u>
Leasehold improvements - at cost	294,318	294,318
Less: Accumulated depreciation	<u>(91,550)</u>	<u>(62,118)</u>
	<u>202,768</u>	<u>232,200</u>
Plant and equipment - at cost	198,359	198,359
Less: Accumulated depreciation	<u>(192,369)</u>	<u>(178,075)</u>
	<u>5,990</u>	<u>20,284</u>
Motor vehicles - at cost	85,960	85,960
Less: Accumulated depreciation	<u>(71,891)</u>	<u>(50,401)</u>
	<u>14,069</u>	<u>35,559</u>
	<u><u>968,121</u></u>	<u><u>1,054,108</u></u>

Reconciliations

Reconciliations of the written down values at the beginning and end of the current financial year are set out below:

	Land	Buildings	Leasehold	Plant and	Motor	Total
	\$	\$	Improvements	Equipment	Vehicles	\$
	\$	\$	\$	\$	\$	\$
Balance at 1 July 2017	390,000	376,065	232,200	20,284	35,559	1,054,108
Depreciation expense	-	(20,771)	(29,432)	(14,294)	(21,490)	(85,987)
Balance at 30 June 2018	<u>390,000</u>	<u>355,294</u>	<u>202,768</u>	<u>5,990</u>	<u>14,069</u>	<u>968,121</u>

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2018

Note 11. Current liabilities - trade and other payables

	2018	2017
	\$	\$
Trade payables	66,895	49,814
BAS payable	33,301	58,226
Accrued expenses	71,810	52,428
Other payables	26,420	27,091
	<u>198,426</u>	<u>187,559</u>

Note 12. Current liabilities - employee benefits

	2018	2017
	\$	\$
Annual leave	225,113	155,028
Long service leave	165,052	165,036
Other leave	16,234	6,942
	<u>406,399</u>	<u>327,006</u>

Note 13. Current liabilities - other current liabilities

	2018	2017
	\$	\$
Grant funding received in advance	617,143	538,725
Government subsidies received in advance	198,871	177,579
Deferred revenue	16,000	15,800
	<u>832,014</u>	<u>732,104</u>

Note 14. Non-current liabilities - employee benefits

	2018	2017
	\$	\$
Long service leave	<u>33,062</u>	<u>50,156</u>

Note 15. Equity - retained surpluses

	2018	2017
	\$	\$
Retained surpluses at the beginning of the financial year	3,039,682	2,963,009
Surplus after income tax expense for the year	<u>536,192</u>	<u>76,673</u>
Retained surpluses at the end of the financial year	<u>3,575,874</u>	<u>3,039,682</u>

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Notes to the financial statements
30 June 2018

Note 16. Key management personnel disclosures

Compensation

The aggregate compensation made to responsible entities and other members of key management personnel of the company is set out below:

	2018 \$	2017 \$
Aggregate compensation	<u>122,166</u>	<u>168,605</u>

Note 17. Related party transactions

Key management personnel

Disclosures relating to key management personnel are set out in note 16.

Transactions with related parties

A company controlled by the CEO's son, supplied computer equipment and IT services to Northern Settlement Services Limited on normal commercial terms and conditions no more favourable than those available to other persons unless stated.

	2018 \$	2017 \$
Provision of IT services (Tantos IT, related party of CEO Lulu Tantos)	34,760	21,372

Receivable from and payable to related parties

The following balances are outstanding at the reporting date in relation to transactions with related parties:

	2018 \$	2017 \$
Current payables:		
Trade payables to other related party	-	1,254

Note 18. Events after the reporting period

No matter or circumstance has arisen since 30 June 2018 that has significantly affected, or may significantly affect the company's operations, the results of those operations, or the company's state of affairs in future financial years.

Note 19. Segment reporting

Northern Settlement Services Limited operates in one economic sector being non-residential care services funded by government and individual users of their facilities.

Note 20. Company details

The registered office, and principle place of business of the company is:

8 Chaucer Street
Hamilton NSW 2303

Northern Settlement Services Limited
Responsible entities' declaration
30 June 2018

In the responsible entities' opinion:

- the attached financial statements and notes comply with the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Act 2012, the Australian Accounting Standards - Reduced Disclosure Requirements, the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission Regulations 2013 and other mandatory professional reporting requirements;
- the attached financial statements and notes give a true and fair view of the company's financial position as at 30 June 2018 and of its performance for the financial year ended on that date; and
- there are reasonable grounds to believe that the company will be able to pay its debts as and when they become due and payable.

Signed in accordance with a resolution of directors.

On behalf of the responsible entities



Jon Chin
Vice Chair

17 October 2018



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